CLASS 8 — ENGLISH GULMOHAR · HARD LEVEL CHAPTER TEST SET 2

Chapter 9: **The Boy Who Broke the Bank** | RBSE Pattern | Session 2026–27

Time: 1 Hour 30 Minutes Name: _____ Roll No.: _____ **Maximum Marks: 40**

General Instructions:

1. All questions are compulsory.
2. Q. 1–10 are Objective Type (1 mark each).
3. Q. 11–14 are Very Short Answer Type (2 marks each).
4. Q. 15–18 are Short Answer Type (3 marks each).
5. Q. 19–20 are Long Answer Type (5 marks each).
6. Internal choice is given in Q. 17 to 20.
7. Write the question number before each answer.
8. Hard level: application and higher-order questions.

SECTION — A (Objective Type Questions) 10 × 1 = 10

Choose the correct option and write it in your answer book.

1. What is the writer satirising? 1

(a) bankers' honesty **(b)** human gullibility and love of gossip
(c) police inefficiency only **(d)** the hill towns

2. 'Neither the Seth nor the clerks ___ at the bank that day' (correct choice): 1

(a) has been **(b)** is **(c)** was **(d)** were

3. The change from 'the sweeper-boy's complaint' into 'the bank is bankrupt' is an example of: 1

(a) lying on purpose
(b) careful reporting
(c) accurate summary
(d) distortion of information through repetition

4. Read: 'You'll be lucky if you get it!' Sitaram's tone here is: 1

(a) teasing, though without malice **(b)** official
(c) sad **(d)** threatening

5. Complete with the right tense: By the time the police arrived, the window ___. 1

(a) had been smashed **(b)** was smashing **(c)** is smashed **(d)** has been smashed

6. The story's central irony is that: 1

(a) a rumour produces the very run on the bank that it predicts
(b) the bank refuses to open
(c) the Seth is arrested
(d) Nathu becomes the manager

7. 'I'll be on the lookout for a new job for you' reveals which value in Sitaram? 1

(a) ambition **(b)** fear
(c) concern for a friend **(d)** selfishness

8. The sentence 'Had the customer waited, he would have learnt the truth' expresses: 1

(a) a command **(b)** a future plan
(c) an unreal past condition **(d)** a present habit

9. Which statement about the bank's problem is best supported? 1

(a) It was made real by the rumour **(b)** It had been robbed
(c) It had no clerks **(d)** It was ruined by the Seth

10. A reader says: 'Nathu is to blame for the whole riot.' A fair reply is: 1

(a) He is fully to blame
(b) He was the manager
(c) He only told the truth about his wages; the exaggeration came from others
(d) He is not in the story

SECTION — B (Very Short Answer Type) 4 × 2 = 8

Answer in about 20–30 words each.

11. Why is the manager's helplessness an important detail? 2

12. Why might the author not tell us who started the rumour in the bank? 2

13. Comment on the pacing of paragraphs 11 to 19. 2

14. How is Nathu a comic figure and yet a sympathetic one? 2

SECTION — C (Short Answer Type) 4 × 3 = 12

Answer in about 40–60 words each.

15. Critically comment on the clerk's relative: why did he decide to call the clerk? 3

16. What does the story suggest about the relationship between rich and poor in a crisis? 3

17. How can the school or a community prevent the spread of false information? Use ideas from the story. 3

OR

'Everyone seems to have gone mad!' Which incident best reflects this madness in your opinion? Why? 3

18. Rewrite in reported speech: The customer said, 'I'll have the rest of my haircut another time.' 3

OR

Explain the relevance of the story to the modern world of social media. 3

SECTION — D (Long Answer Type) 2 × 5 = 10

Answer in about 100–150 words each.

19. Discuss the story as a satire on gossip and herd behaviour in society. 5

OR

'Nathu is the only person who comes out of the story with some dignity.' Do you agree? Give reasons. 5

20. 'The bank was ruined not by poverty but by fear.' Examine the statement. 5

OR

How does the story show the importance of verifying information before acting? Write an essay of about 150 words. 5

END OF QUESTION PAPER Total: 40 Marks

MASTERMIND